Hazāras. They killed it to quench their appetites, half part in the form of kebab and remaining roasted like mutton. Babur has said in *Baburnama* that, ‘such good camel-flesh had never been tasted; some could not tell it [apart] from mutton’.

The next day, Babur headed with his party to hunt for the Hazāras in their winter camp. Around nine in the morning, a man came running and informed me that the Hazāras had blocked a crossing with branches of trees. The winter was acute, and the snow lay deep. One couldn’t move anywhere else except a bit on roads. No one could spot the meadows, which in general used to be swampy. There were no streams either. The only way to cross the streams was through the culverts and the bridge of the road. The Hazāras had chopped and laid the branches at the bridge over frozen water. As Babur reached there along with his men, the array of arrows began to shower from both sides. And then in the madness to prove his loyalty and bravery, Muḥammad ‘Alī Mubashshir Beg jumped and barged into the blocked road without his mail. He was shot in the belly, and he succumbed to the injury immediately. Babur had recently promoted him to the rank of Beg and he considered him deserving of all favours showered upon him.

Babur and his party had rushed behind the Hazāras in haste. Most of them didn’t wear the mail. As arrows came in, Babur’s men began to fall one by one. Yet, Babur was confident to get through. Anxious and worried Yūsuf Aḥmad said, ‘Bare like this you go into it! I have seen two arrows go close to your head!’

Babur replied wearing a smile, ‘Don’t fear! Many as good arrows as these have flown past my head!’

And then while words were being exchanged, Qāsim Beg leading his men, was able to cruise through and cross the stream. Now, the Hazāras were butchered in the worst possible way. They didn’t stand much of a chance in front of Babur’s well-trained men. They began to fly away looking at the force that was arriving in retaliation after the crossing. Almost all of them were unhorsed and put to death.

Babur was pleased with Qāsim Beg’s feat and as a reward, he offered him Bangash. Two other people who had pleased Babur in this fight were Ḥātim the armourer and Bābā Qulī’s Kīpik. They were bestowed Shaikh Darwīsh’s office of qūr-begī and the office of Muhammad ‘Alī Mubashshir, respectively.

While this victory was accomplished, Sulṭān Qulī Chūnāq had begun to chase the Hazāras. Alas! The time went by but there was no coming back of him.

Babur decided to go ahead with whoever he had around. Many sheep and herds of horses were found in the vicinity of the Hazāra winter camp. Babur